

Incident Handler's Journal - Incident Detection and Response

1. Project overview

This project focused on documenting and analyzing multiple cybersecurity incident response scenarios using an Incident Handler's Journal . Throughout the activities, I practiced recording incident details, identifying indicators of compromise (IoCs), analyzing network traffic, investigating malicious file hashes, and documenting findings using industry-standard incident response methodologies.

2. Key Activities

- documented a ransomware incident using the 5 W's framework (Who, What, When, Where, Why)
- Analyzed packet capture (PCAP) file using Wireshark to identify network activity and understand traffic patterns
- Captured and filtered network traffic using tcpdump through the command-line interface
- Investigated a suspicious SHA256 file hash using VirusTotal and validated indicators of compromise
- Recorded observations, findings, and lessons learned in an Incident Handler's Journal
- Applied incident response lifecycle concepts, including Detection, Analysis, Containment, Eradication, and recovery
- Reflected on challenges, learning progress and security awareness improvements.

3. Skill demonstrated

- incident documentation
- Incident response fundamentals
- Security event analysis
- Wireshark
- Tcpdump
- VirusTotal
- Indicator of Compromise (IoC) Analysis
- Security investigation
- Analytical thinking
- Technical reporting

4. Key learning outcome

This project strengthened my understanding of how security incidents are detected, investigated, documented and escalated. I gained practical experience using security analysis tools, identifying malicious activity, working with indicator of compromise, and documenting incidents in a structured and professional manner. The project also reinforced the importance of accurate documentation and repeatable incident response processes within cybersecurity operations.